Hussain Guru, and Mohammad Afzal; and Shaukat's wife Afsan (aka Navjot) Guru. These were the only four to be arrested.

In the tense days that followed, Parliament was adjourned. On 21 December 2001 India recalled its High Commissioner from Pakistan, suspended air, rail and bus communications and banned over-flights. It put into motion a massive mobilization of its war machinery, and moved more than half a million troops to the Pakistan border. Foreign embassies evacuated their staff and citizens and tourists travelling to India were issued cautionary Travel Advisories. The world watched with bated breath as the subcontinent was taken to the brink of nuclear war. (All this cost India an estimated Rs 10,000 crores of public money. A few hundred soldiers died just in the panicky process of mobilization.)

Almost three and a half years later, on 5 August 2005, the Supreme Court delivered its final judgement in the case. It endorsed the view that the Parliament Attack be looked upon as an act of war. It said, 'The attempted attack on Parliament is an undoubted invasion of the sovereign attribute of the State including the Government of India which is its *alter ego* . . . the deceased terrorists were roused and impelled to action by a strong anti- Indian feeling as the writing on the fake Home Ministry sticker found on the car (Ex. PW1/8) reveals.' It went on to say, 'the *modus operandi* adopted by the hardcore "fidayeens" are all demonstrative of launching a war against the Government of India.'

The text on the fake Home Ministry sticker read as follows:

> INDIA IS A VERY BAD COUNTRY AND WE HATE INDIA WE WANT TO DESTROY INDIA AND WITH THE GRACE OF GOD WE WILL DO IT GOD IS WITH US AND WE WILL TRY OUR BEST. THIS EDIET WAJPAI AND ADVANI WE WILL KILL THEM. THEY HAVE KILLED MANY INNOCENT PEOPLE AND THEY ARE VERY BAD PERSONS THERE BROTHER BUSH IS ALSO A VERY BAD PERSON HE WILL BE NEXT TARGET HE IS ALSO THE KILLER OF INNOCENT PEOPLE HE HAVE TO DIE AND WE WILL DO IT.

This subtly-worded sticker-manifesto was displayed on the windscreen of the car bomb as it drove into Parliament. (Given the amount of text, it's a wonder the driver could see anything at all. Maybe that's why he collided with the Vice-President's cavalcade?)

The police charge sheet was filed in a special fast- track trial court designated for cases under the Prevention of Terrorism Act (POTA). The trial